Ryan Meinerding concept art.

"The suit Steve Rogers picks up in the Smithsonian is meant to represent the suit he used in WWII, but the actual suit he wore when he went into the ice was presumably damaged beyond repair," Meinerding continues. "Maybe it's in a more somber part of the exhibit, but this main costume on display is meant to foster idealist ideas about America and WWII—as well as being that red-white-and-blue iconic symbol of simple patriotism. We took a few liberties in updating the suit to be slightly more 'super hero,' though this movie is one of the more realistic takes on a super hero that Marvel has done. Injecting a little more super hero into that WWII suit was a welcome addition."